PTA
Parent Teacher Association

ARENA SCHOOL

PTA PARENT COFFEE · OCTOBER 14, 2026

The future of jobs and education in the age of AI

# Our Kids' Jobs *Don't Exist Yet.*

*So Which Skills Will Matter?*

THIS MORNING

# From what's changing at work *to what you can do at home.*

1

## Work is being rewritten

*Even in the safest careers*

2

## Three skills decide who gets ahead

*Agency, taste, and craft*

3

## What families can do now

*Three takeaways*

# We trained at ISB, Caltech, Harvard, Brown, and Tsinghua, then did *the jobs AI is now automating.*



## Jing Jing Yang

ISB CLASS OF 2019

*Has worked with Chinese tech and AI companies on going global since high school*

STUDIED INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF BEIJING 北京顺义国际学校 · BROWN · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED · Deloitte. · CICC 中金公司 · KIMI



## Phillip An

FORBES 30 UNDER 30

*Co-founder and CEO of Skylarq AI*
*Co-founder and ex-COO of Homebase (raised $50M+)*

STUDIED Caltech · HARVARD · 清華大學 Tsinghua University

WORKED Goldman Sachs · McKinsey&Company · LinkedIn

THE QUESTION BEHIND TODAY'S TALK

# When AI can do all of these in seconds, what must our children *still learn to do?*

SECTION 1

# AI is already changing work, *including the careers families trust most.*

Examples in medicine, law, and finance


1 Work is being rewritten
*Even in the safest careers*

2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
*Agency, taste, and craft*

3 What families can do now
*Three takeaways*

ANTHROPIC ECONOMIC INDEX · BASED ON REAL USE OF CLAUDE

# In about half of all jobs, AI is already used for *at least a quarter of the tasks.*

ANTHROP\C

Occupations where AI is used in at least a quarter of tasks



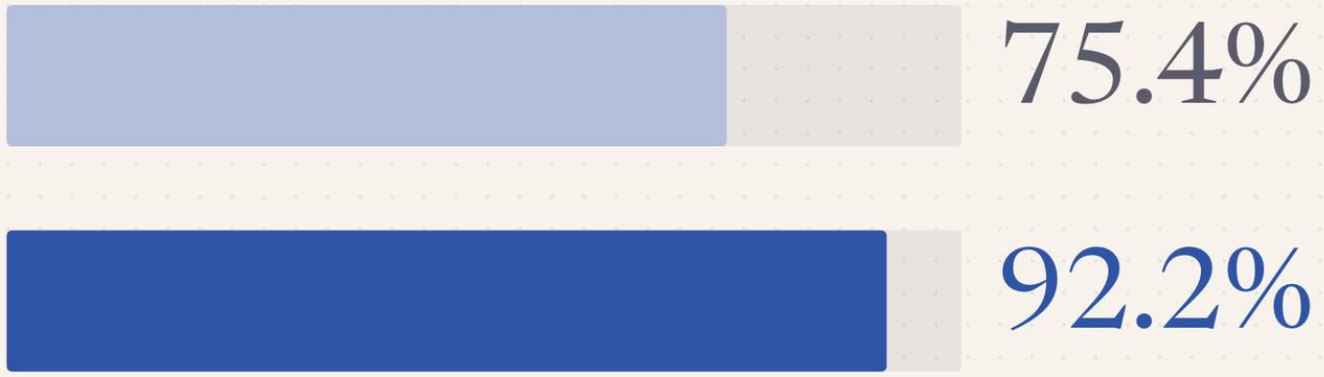

Anthropic Economic Index, Jan 15, 2026: share of occupations using AI for at least 25% of their tasks (36% in the January 2025 report). The 2026 figure pools data across reports and reflects how people use Claude, not a census of every worker.

DOCTORS · A RANDOMIZED TRIAL IN CHINA

# With AI, eye doctors got the diagnosis right *92% of the time. Without it, 75%.*

THE EYEFM TRIAL · NATURE MEDICINE

Patients given the correct diagnosis




Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Tsinghua University, and others, Nature Medicine, Aug 28, 2025: 668 patients and 16 eye doctors at one center, retinal screening; correct referrals also rose, from 80.5% to 92.2%

# Law students using AI got *34% to 140% more done* on most legal tasks.

A US RANDOMIZED TRIAL

+34–140%

more work done with AI, on 5 of 6 legal tasks




LAWYERS IN MAINLAND CHINA

93%

of lawyers and trainees already use AI at work




LARGE US LAW FIRMS

–7.5%

new-graduate hires in 2025, the first drop since 2014




Schwarcz, Manning, Prescott, and others, "AI-Powered Lawyering", 127 law students, 2026; LexisNexis survey of 404 legal professionals in mainland China, via Caixin, Aug 29, 2025; NALP, Class of 2025, Aug 5, 2026, which does not attribute the drop to AI alone

BANKERS · ICBC AND STANDARD CHARTERED

# At ICBC, China's biggest bank, AI did work equal to *about 13% of its staff* in 2025.

**55,000** person-years

ICBC

of work done by AI "digital employees", at a bank with 409,758 staff

**7,800** roles

standard chartered

in corporate functions to go by 2030, replacing what its CEO called "lower-value human capital."

ICBC 2025 Annual Report, March 27, 2026 (13% is our calculation); Standard Chartered investor event, May 19, 2026: 15% of corporate-function roles; Bill Winters later apologized for the wording

AMAZON · FROM THE MEMO TO THE CUTS

# Amazon's CEO said AI will shrink its corporate workforce. *It has since cut about 30,000 roles.*

amazon

**JUNE 17, 2025**

## The CEO's memo

AI "will reduce our total corporate workforce"

**OCTOBER 28, 2025**

## 14,000

corporate roles cut

**JANUARY 28, 2026**

## 16,000

more corporate roles cut

Amazon: Andy Jassy memo, June 17, 2025; workforce memos, Oct 28, 2025 and Jan 28, 2026. Amazon also cited cutting layers of management, and Jassy later said the October cuts were "not even really AI-driven."

WHO STAYS · FROM THE SAME MEMO, JUNE 2025

# “Those who embrace this change, become conversant in AI … will be well-positioned to *have high impact.*”

amazon

Andy Jassy, CEO of Amazon

*Memo to employees, June 17, 2025*

WHAT THE SKILLS ARE WORTH · PWC 2026 GLOBAL AI JOBS BAROMETER

# The pay gap is already here: jobs that require AI skills pay *62% more.*

62%

PWC

higher advertised pay for jobs that require AI skills



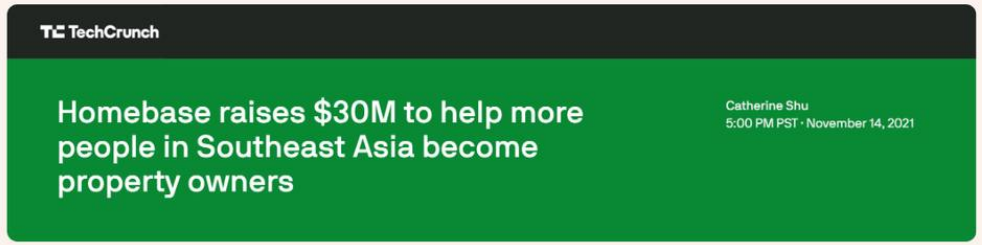

PwC 2026 Global AI Jobs Barometer, June 15, 2026: average wage premium in job ads across 27 countries; it does not control for education or experience

CASE STUDY · PHILLIP'S COMPANIES

# My last company had about 120 people.
# *My AI-native company has fewer than five.*

BEFORE · CO-FOUNDER AND COO

homebase




*About* 120 people across sales, marketing, product, design, and operations

BACKED BY Y Combinator Goodwater partech

→

NOW · CO-FOUNDER AND CEO

Skylarq

Product · Design · Marketing · Social media · Sales

*Once separate hires, now two or three of us using AI.*

<5 people on the whole team

Building AI agents that run sales and go-to-market.

*If I hire again, I'll only hire people who are AI-native and highly leveraged with AI.*

YOUNG WORKERS FEEL IT FIRST · STANFORD, US PAYROLL DATA

# In the most exposed jobs, young people are already *19% behind.*

AGES 22 TO 25

## −19%

employment in AI-exposed jobs, against peers their age in less-exposed jobs

EXPERIENCED WORKERS

## No gap

in the same AI-exposed jobs

Brynjolfsson, Chandar, and Chen, “Canaries in the Coal Mine?”, revised August 2026; descriptive, not a causal estimate

CHINA · 1,333 GRADUATING STUDENTS, MAY 2026

# In China, 91% of graduating students changed their job plans because of AI, but *only 57% are learning AI skills.*

CHINA YOUTH DAILY

ADJUSTED JOB PLANS BECAUSE OF AI

91.1%

YET ONLY

ACTIVELY LEARNING AI SKILLS

56.6%

China Youth Daily Social Survey Center and wenjuan.com, survey of 1,333 graduating students, published May 14, 2026

SECTION 2

# So three skills now decide who gets ahead: *agency, taste, and craft.*


1 Work is being rewritten
*Even in the safest careers*

2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
*Agency, taste, and craft*

3 What families can do now
*Three takeaways*

# AI is making the how cheap: writing code, drafts, *and analysis.*

75%

**GOOGLE**

of new code is now drafted by AI, then approved by engineers

52%

**BAIDU**

of new code is now generated by AI, and its CEO wants 80% to 90%

Sundar Pichai, up from 50% last fall, Google Cloud Next / company blog, April 22, 2026. Robin Li, Baidu World 2025, Nov 13, 2025

WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM · FUTURE OF JOBS 2025 · 1,000+ EMPLOYERS

# So value moves to what to do, *and whether it's good.*

HOW TO DO IT

Write the code

Draft the memo

Run the analysis

WHAT · WHETHER IT'S GOOD

Decide what to build

Judge the output

Lead people and AI

ESSENTIAL NOW · RISING THROUGH 2030




WEF Future of Jobs 2025, Jan 7, 2025, Fig. 3.3 essential now; Fig. 3.4 rising through 2030. Microsoft 2026 Work Trend Index; LinkedIn Skills on the Rise 2026

NAME THE SCARCE SKILLS

# Agency chooses, taste judges, *and craft finishes.*

THE THREE SKILLS

01

## Agency

Decide what is worth building before anyone assigns it.

02

## Taste

Judge whether the output is actually good.

03

## Craft

Finish it so people can trust it.

IN A HIGH SCHOOL STUDENT'S WEEK

# What do *agency, taste, and craft* look like in practice?

BEFORE

## *"Just give me the answer."*

The homework gets done.
The thinking gets skipped.

AGENCY

Sees a younger brother stuck on fractions and builds him a practice game with AI, without being asked.

TASTE

Builds a deck for a class talk and keeps reworking it, not just the design but the clearest way to say it.

CRAFT

Tests the club website on Grandma's phone, fixes the tiny text and the broken sign-up form, then shares it.

WHAT CHILDREN NEED

# Skills grow from practice *with structure.*



## A real project

*with something at stake*



## A coach

*who asks how you checked it*



## Honest feedback

*from real people*

NATIONAL SURVEY OF SCHOOLS · CHINA NATIONAL ACADEMY OF EDUCATIONAL SCIENCES, 2026

# Studies show most schools still lack teachers ready to teach AI, *so families can help now.*




of schools have too few teachers ready to teach AI




of teachers lack confidence in teaching AI

CNAES survey, 3,653 responses across eastern, central, and western China, May–June 2026, published Aug 19, 2026. In the US, 68% of teachers had no school or district training on AI (Gallup and Walton Family Foundation, 2025).

SECTION 3

# So start building these skills now, *while the gap is still small.*


1 Work is being rewritten
*Even in the safest careers*

2 Three skills decide who gets ahead
*Agency, taste, and craft*

3 What families can do now
*Three takeaways*

*Takeaway*

1

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

# Know the latest AI tools, *so you can guide your child.*

1 Know the tools | 2 Use AI for real tasks | 3 The best time to build

TAKEAWAY 1 · PERSONAL AI AGENTS, OCTOBER 2026

# Who has heard of these? Behind them, *thousands of new AI models appear every day.*

Kimi | Muse | Instinct | Manus | Genspark | OpenClaw

## 200+ MORE AI TOOLS YOU COULD TRY TODAY

ChatGPT Claude Gemini DeepSeek Doubao Qwen Yuanbao ERNIE Grok Copilot Meta AI Le Chat Perplexity Poe Character.AI Pi ChatGLM MiniMax Hunyuan Spark Baichuan StepFun Skywork Metaso Felo You.com Phind Consensus Elicit Scite NotebookLM Notion AI Gamma Tome Beautiful.ai Pitch Canva Figma Make Framer Webflow Lovable Bolt v0 Replit Cursor Windsurf GitHub Copilot TRAE Claude Code Codex Devin Tabnine Cody Zed Warp JetBrains AI Amazon Q Gemini CLI Qoder CodeBuddy Comate Kiro Midjourney DALL·E Ideogram Leonardo Firefly Stable Diffusion FLUX Krea Recraft Playground Lovart Dreamina Liblib Kolors Wanxiang Sora Veo Runway Pika Luma Kling Hailuo Vidu PixVerse Seedance HeyGen Synthesia D-ID CapCut Descript OpusClip Captions Hedra Higgsfield InVideo Flow Suno Udio ElevenLabs Murf Speechify Otter Fireflies Granola Whisper Krisp AIVA Comet Dia Atlas Flowith Coze Dify n8n Zapier Make Lindy Relevance AI Gumloop CrewAI LangChain AutoGPT Cue WorkBuddy Fellou AutoGLM Grammarly Jasper Copy.ai Writesonic Sudowrite QuillBot Wordtune DeepL Rytr Lex Mem Reflect Superhuman Motion Reclaim Clockwise Fathom tl;dv Read AI Tactiq Zoom AI Slack AI Miro AI Whimsical Napkin Glean Raycast Monica Sider MaxAI Merlin HARPA Khanmigo Duolingo Max Quizlet Photomath Brainly Gauth Question.AI Speak Praktika ELSA MagicSchool Brisk Diffit Curipod SchoolAI Squirrel AI Spline Meshy Tripo Uizard Stitch Visily Relume Hugging Face Supabase Firebase Studio AI Studio OpenRouter Ollama LM Studio Jan Julius Llama Gemma Adobe Express Designer Pictory Lumen5 Notta Plaud

## HUGGING FACE

*The world's largest AI model library*

# 4,386

new AI models published on Monday, October 12, 2026

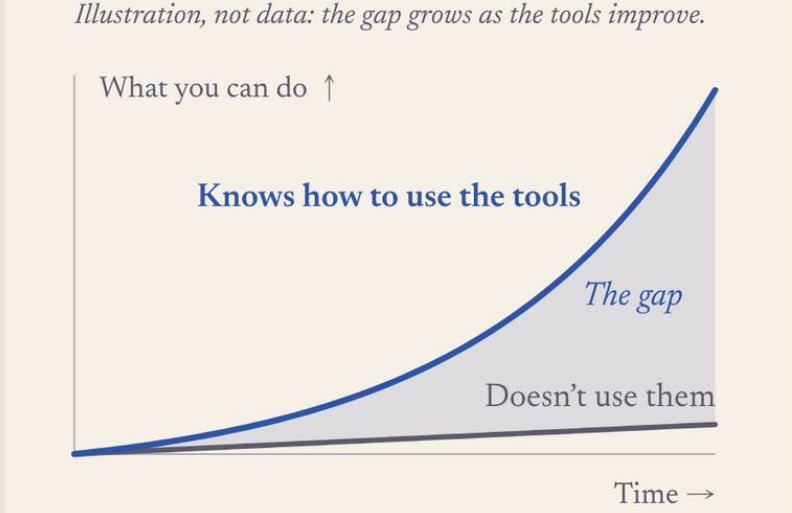
*About 3 every minute* *3.1 million in all*

Hugging Face Hub API: 4,386 public models created Oct 12, 2026 (UTC); huggingface.co/models lists 3,145,598. Both checked Oct 13, 2026. Tools: each tool's own site

TAKEAWAY 1 · METR TIME HORIZON 1.1 · JANUARY 29, 2026

# AI's ability doubles about every 7 months, so *knowing how to use it compounds.*




METR, Time Horizon 1.1, Jan 29, 2026: doubled about every 7 months. METR data, checked Oct 13, 2026: GPT-4 ~4 min, Claude 3.7 ~1 hour, Claude Opus 4.5 ~4.9 hours, Claude Opus 4.6 ~12 hours. The right panel is an illustration, not data.

*Takeaway*

2

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

# Use AI on real tasks with real stakes, *like a school project or a job application.*

*1* Know the tools | *2* Use AI for real tasks | *3* The best time to build

CASE STUDY · MY KIMI STORY · 1 OF 3

# Two months into learning AI, *I applied to Kimi with tools I built.*

WHAT I BUILT

**An AI interview prep tool and a social media tracker**

Plus a GitHub portfolio of things I'd built with AI.

→

IN THE INTERVIEW

**Both tools, shown live in the interview**

My AI skills, and my view of Kimi and the global market.

→

LIVE DEMO

**arenaschool.org/case-study-examples**

Both tools are on this site.

KIMI | *For a non-technical role, what I had built with AI made the case.*

CASE STUDY · MY KIMI STORY · 2 OF 3

# At Kimi, I handed AI the repetitive work *and kept the judgment calls.*

WHAT I KEPT BUILDING

**Tools for my own workflow**

Built with AI to make my everyday work faster.

→

HOW I USED THEM

**Repetitive tasks, handed off**

I chose which parts to handle myself.

→

WHAT CHANGED

**I progressed quickly**

First within my team, then across teams.

KIMI | *So I could focus on the decisions that mattered.*

# While still doing growth work, *I was also put in charge of HR.*

Kimi is an AI lab, so it expects more of its people. But it's a preview:
in five to ten years, this is likely what entry-level jobs everywhere will ask for.

THE REASON

**Leadership believed the company needed more AI-native employees**

Even for non-technical teams in marketing, sales, and product.

→

WHAT I LOOK FOR FIRST

**Real fluency with AI tools**

Knowing what to hand to AI, and what to keep.

→

THEN

**Agency, taste, and craft**

Used well, AI frees your energy for more creative, impactful work.

KIMI | *Companies now value AI fluency, even in roles that don't need technical skills.*

*Takeaway*

3

WHAT FAMILIES CAN DO NOW

# Despite all this, it's one of the best times ever to be a kid, *and the best time to build.*

*1* Know the tools | *2* Use AI for real tasks | *3* The best time to build

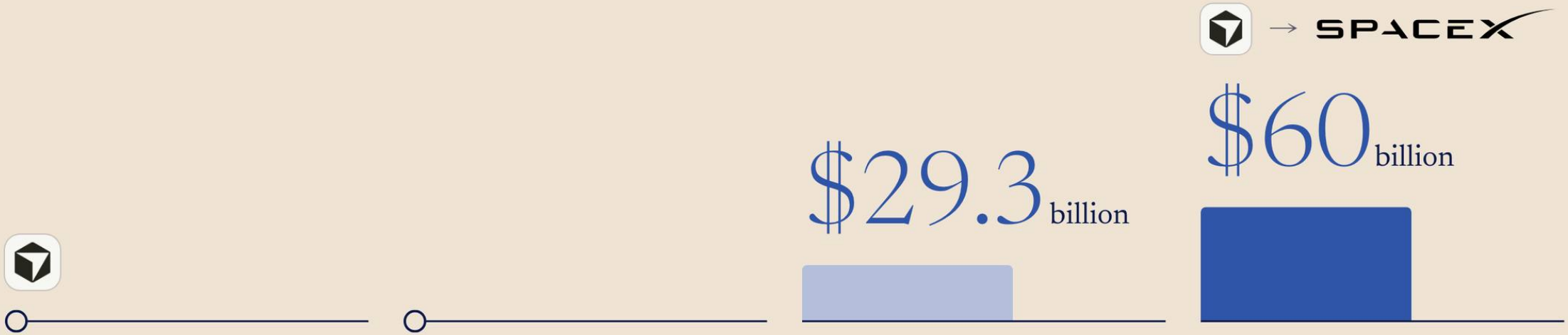
TAKEAWAY 3 · THEN AND NOW

# When we were young, ideas stayed in a notebook. Today a child can *make one real.*

| WHEN WE WERE YOUNG | | TODAY |
|---|---|---|
| Built by hand, and slowly. | → | AI builds a first version in an afternoon. |
| A team, and years of training. | → | One child can launch a first version in a week. |
| Only the family saw what you made. | → | Real users, before they leave school. |

TAKEAWAY 3 · CURSOR, 2022 TO 2026

# Four MIT friends started Cursor in 2022. SpaceX bought it for *$60 billion.*




2022

**Four MIT friends**

start an AI coding tool

2023

**Cursor launches**

an AI code editor

NOV 2025

**Series D**

valuation, with over $1B annualized revenue

AUG 2026

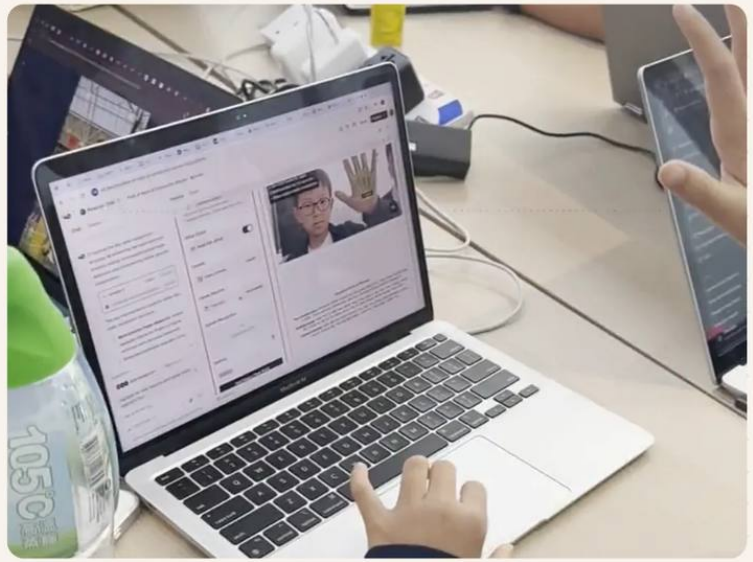
**Acquired by SpaceX**

an all-stock deal

Cursor, Series D post, Nov 13, 2025; Reuters, CNBC, and Bloomberg, June 16, 2026; SpaceX Form 8-K and PitchBook, Aug 14, 2026

TAKEAWAY 3 · WHAT CHILDREN CAN BUILD

# In five days, an 11-year-old *turned sign language into speech.*



*Built in five days by a seventh grader*

| | |
|---|---|
| *01* **Agency**<br>FIND A PROBLEM | He chose sign language to speech because his cousin is deaf. Nobody assigned it. |
| *02* **Taste**<br>REAL-USER FEEDBACK | He kept improving it after the demo, because his grandmother couldn't use the first version yet. |
| *03* **Craft**<br>FINISH AND LAUNCH | The hardest part wasn't the AI. It was audio clear enough for her to trust. |

AI tools did the building. *He did the choosing, judging, and finishing.*

EXAMPLE TOOLS

IF YOU REMEMBER ONE THING

# Work is being rewritten.

*Children who choose, judge, and finish with AI will thrive.*

1

## Work is being rewritten

AI is already used in about half of all jobs.

2

## Three skills matter

Agency, taste, and craft: choose, judge, and finish.

3

## Become AI native

It's never too early, or too late, to start.

---

*The tools are new for everyone. That makes this the best time to be a kid.*

# Thank you! *We welcome your questions.*

TODAY'S SLIDES

*arenaschool.org/talk*

TOOL WALKTHROUGHS

**arenaschool.org/case-study-examples**

Step-by-step walkthroughs to open on your own time.